

# Quantitative Content Analysis of Human Trafficking Coverage

Academic Data Analysis Project | The Punch & The Guardian

## Project Overview

Undergraduate quantitative content-analysis project examining the frequency, prominence, journalistic genre, direction, and forms of human-trafficking coverage in The Punch and The Guardian newspapers.

## Data Scope

|                |                   |            |                            |
|----------------|-------------------|------------|----------------------------|
| Study period   | 2019-2020         | Population | 1,462 issues               |
| Sample         | 400 issues        | Allocation | 200 per newspaper          |
| Relevant items | 282 stories/items | Sampling   | Simple random              |
| Instrument     | Coding sheet      | Analysis   | Frequencies, %, cross-tabs |

## Analytical Workflow

Research question -> sampling -> content collection -> coding -> categorisation -> frequency/percentage analysis -> cross-tabulation -> comparison -> interpretation -> recommendations

## Key Results

| Area             | Result                                                                                                                       |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Coverage         | The Punch: 177 (62.8%); The Guardian: 105 (37.2%)                                                                            |
| Prominence       | Inside pages 86.5%; front page 12.1%; back page 1.4%                                                                         |
| Genre            | Straight news 68.1%; picture news 16.3%; feature 10.3%; editorial cartoon 3.2%; editorial 2.1%                               |
| Trafficking type | Forced criminal activities 50.7%; sexual exploitation 25.2%; forced labour 12.4%; people smuggling 10.3%; organ removal 1.4% |
| Direction        | Positive 63.8%; negative 28.7%; neutral 7.4%                                                                                 |

## Interpretation

The Punch accounted for a larger share of the identified stories. Most coverage appeared on inside pages, indicating limited prominence. Straight news dominated, while features and editorials were comparatively limited, suggesting less in-depth treatment.

## Skills Demonstrated

Quantitative content analysis | structured data collection | coding and categorisation | sampling | frequency and percentage analysis | cross-tabulation | comparative analysis | pattern identification | data interpretation | evidence-based reporting

## Portfolio Note

The submitted thesis explicitly documents frequencies, percentages and cross-tabulations. SPSS was used during the project according to the project author, although the thesis itself does not explicitly name the software.